

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ Q 9 4
♥ J 9 8 5
♦ Q J 10 5
♣ J 10

♠ A J

♥ K Q 4 3

♦ A 7 3

♣ K 6 5 2

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ K 10 7 2

♥ 10 6

♦ 9 8 2

♣ Q 9 4 3

♠ 8 6 5 3

♥ A 7 2

♦ K 6 4

♣ A 8 7

*West**North**East**South*

1NT

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by North

Lead: ♠ 2

[showcards W:S2 N:S3]

The bidding has been as shown. Partner led the ♠ 2, dummy played the ♠ 3

Play the ♠ Q. This is a perfect example of why you should USUALLY play Third-hand-high.

If you do not put your ♠ Q on this trick declarer will get an undeserved winner with his ♠ J. In this Deal it will be his ninth trick. Play Third-hand-high and he will go down, otherwise he will make his contract.

Board 2

South Deals

None Vul

♠ 9 5
 ♥ Q J 9 5
 ♦ A J 6 2
 ♣ 9 7 4

♠ K 10 7 4

♥ 10 4

♦ 9 5 3

♣ A Q J 3



♠ 2

♥ A 8 7 6 2

♦ K 8 4

♣ 10 8 5 2

♠ A Q J 8 6 3

♥ K 3

♦ Q 10 7

♣ K 6

West	North	East	South
			1 ♠
Pass	3 ♠	Pass	4 ♠
All Pass			

4 ♠ by South

Lead: ♥Q

will pull trumps and discard two red losers on dummy's ♣ and make an overtrick.

[showcards W:HQ N:H4]

The bidding has been as shown. Partner led the ♥Q, dummy played the ♥4

Play the ♥A. You dare not play low for fear declarer might win a singleton ♥K.

And when you win the first trick, (the ♥K does NOT fall), you have to decide what to do next. Do not just return the suit like a robot since it is obvious that you have no more ♥ winners and you surely won't win any ♣ tricks.

You need to switch to a ♦, and the ♦4, (low from an honor) is recommended.

Played this way you will defeat the contract by one trick. If you allow declarer to win the first trick he

Board 3

North Deals

E-W Vul

♠ Q 7 4 2

♥ 9 7 4 3

♦ 8 7

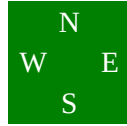
♣ Q J 2

♠ A 10 6

♥ K J 2

♦ A 10 5 3

♣ K 8 5



♠ J 5 3

♥ Q 10 6

♦ K 6 2

♣ A 10 6 4

♠ K 9 8

♥ A 8 5

♦ Q J 9 4

♣ 9 7 3

West

North

East

South

1NT

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by North

Lead: ♣4

which would be too bad for your side.

[showcards W:C4 N:C3]

The bidding has been as shown. Partner led the ♣4, dummy played the ♣3

Third-hand-high is usually a good plan to follow, certainly that is true in this deal. But that doesn't mean you should blindly play your HIGHEST card, rather you should play the LOWEST of high-equals.

In other words, in this case you should play the ♣J, which is equal to the ♣Q.

If instead you play the ♣Q, figuring it makes no difference, you'd be right that it makes no difference to you. But partner would then assume that it is declarer with the ♣J, and when he obtains the lead with the ♦K he will be unlikely to lead another ♣,

Board 4

South Deals

None Vul

♠ Q 8 7 3

♥ 10 5

♦ A 5 4 2

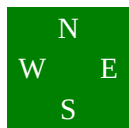
♣ 8 4 2

♠ J 6 4

♥ Q 8

♦ K 9 7 3

♣ K Q J 10



♠ K 10 2

♥ 6 4 3

♦ Q J 10 6

♣ A 6 5

♠ A 9 5

♥ A K J 9 7 2

♦ 8

♣ 9 7 3

West	North	East	South
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Pass

2♣

Pass

1♥

Pass

4♥

All Pass

4♥ by South

Lead: ♠3
correctly.

[showcards W:S3 N:S4]

The bidding has been as shown. Partner led the ♠3, dummy played the ♠4

Play the ♠10.

Partner's low ♠ lead tells you that he has an honor in the suit. There are only two ♠ honors you can't see, and you know he wouldn't underlead an Ace at a suit contract. So partner holds the ♠Q.

You can see clearly what would happen if you played Third-hand-high and put on your ♠K. Declarer would win his ♠A and could then set up a second ♠ trick by leading toward dummy's ♠J.

By playing the ♠10 you force declarer to win with the ♠A if he wants the trick. But however he plays he can only make one ♠ trick when you play

For your side, 2 ♠ tricks and the two minor Aces spell defeat.

Board 5

North Deals

N-S Vul

♠ A J 9 2
 ♥ 10 7 5 3
 ♦ A 4 2
 ♣ 9 7

♠ 6 4

♥ K Q 2

♦ K J 10 3

♣ A K 8 3

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ Q 10 8 7

♥ 9 6 4

♦ 8 7 5

♣ 10 6 4

♠ K 5 3

♥ A J 8

♦ Q 9 6

♣ Q J 5 2

West

North

East

South

1NT

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by North

Lead: ♠ 7

you to pick up dummy's ♠ K and four ♠ winners. Along with the ♦ A you will defeat the contract.

[showcards W:S7 N:S3]

The bidding has been as shown. Partner led the ♠ 7, dummy played the ♠ 3

Play the ♠ 2.

Partner has led a small card, so it is surely fourth-down. That means you should automatically apply the Rule of Eleven.

11 minus 7 equals 4, so there are just 4 cards higher than the 7 between dummy, you, and declarer. **AND YOU CAN SEE ALL FOUR OF THEM.**

Declarer has no card that can beat the ♠ 7, and the only way you can beat this contract is to let partner's ♠ 7 hold the trick. He will continue the suit, allowing

If you play ANY card except your ♠ 2 on the first trick you will not be able to win four tricks in the suit because you cannot get East back into the lead. And declarer will make the contract easily.